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India's schools

Schools, enrolment, special categories and teaching resources, with market sizing for a Classes 3-8 CT&AI programme

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Main data: UDISE+ 2025-26 (released July 2026) and official sources, cited throughout

Report title: "CBSE's mandate meets India's device gap"

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About this report

Figures come from official sources (UDISE+, Ministry of Education, KVS, NVS, CBSE, Parliament answers, MoSPI, TRAI) and are cited inline; many UDISE+ figures are taken from compilations of the official tables because the booklets could not be fetched. Every figure states its reference year. This report's own calculations are marked (est.) with the method given. Section "Four data breaks limit how far the numbers stretch" lists the data-quality caveats and conflicting figures.

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Summary

India's school system is huge, mostly government-run and still mostly offline. **UDISE+ 2025-26 counts 14,66,682 schools.** Of these, 10,05,245 (68.5%) are government, 79,261 (5.4%) government-aided, 3,41,689 (23.3%) private unaided and 40,487 (2.8%) "others". Together they serve **24.72 crore students and employ 1.03 crore teachers** (EFA key indicators). Government schools hold under half of Classes 1-12 enrolment (49.7%), and private unaided schools hold 38.0% (40.0% including pre-primary). The Classes 3-8 band that CodeSchool targets has an **estimated 12.4 crore students**. Only **33,248 schools, about 2.3% of the total, are CBSE-affiliated** (CBSE SARAS, accessed 6 Nov 2026). Those schools carry the Computational Thinking and AI (CT&AI) requirement for Classes 3-8 from 2026-27, so they are CodeSchool's core market. They hold an estimated 45 lakh to 1.4 crore Classes 3-8 students, with a central estimate of about 88 lakh, or about Rs 460 crore a year at the Rs 449/599 pack prices. A far larger voluntary pool sits in state-board private schools: about 4 crore students. That pool is budget-constrained and short of devices. School digital coverage is growing quickly, but most of it is presence, not capacity. 67.4% of schools report internet and 63.1% a computer usable for teaching. Only 36.5% have a working desktop, 22.1% a working projector and 33.9% a smart classroom. Government schools trail far behind, with 25.5% holding a working desktop (EFA digital divide). The Offline Programme is therefore CodeSchool's main product, not a fallback. The Online Programme fits roughly the 40-53% of private and aided schools with a usable device and connection (an estimate). Every trend in this report has to be read against UDISE+'s 2022-23 methodology break, and every device figure against the fact that UDISE+ records whether a school has a device, not how many.

*Units and conventions: 1 lakh = 100,000; 1 crore = 10 million. "2025-26" means the UDISE+ round with a 31 March 2026 data cut-off, released on 7 July 2026 (Vision IAS). The official UDISE+ booklets were too large to fetch, so most national figures come from Prof. Arun C. Mehta's compilation of the official data (former NIEPA; cited as "EFA"), which this research checked for internal consistency. Every figure marked **(est.)** is this report's own calculation, not an official statistic.*

Government runs 69% of schools but teaches under half the pupils

The school count has fallen by about 42,000 since 2020-21. Nearly all of the fall is government-school consolidation. The private unaided count dipped after 2021-22 and has since recovered almost to its 2020-21 level. Between 2024-25 and 2025-26, government schools fell by 8,077 (-0.8%) while private unaided schools rose by 2,106 (+0.6%) (EFA 2025-26 analysis). Zero-enrolment schools fell from 7,993 to 5,663 in a year, and West Bengal accounts for 4,133 of the remainder (EFA single-teacher schools).

Table 1. Schools by management, all-India (UDISE+) — source: EFA key indicators; 2023-24 and 2024-25 confirmed by Careers360

Management	2020-21	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26	Share 2025-26
State government	10,29,978	10,13,855	10,15,504	10,11,164	10,03,051	68.4%
Kendriya Vidyalayas	1,242	1,249	1,251	1,253	1,286	0.1%
Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas	643	648	650	653	665	<0.1%
Other central government	316	258	255	252	243	<0.1%
Total government	10,32,179	10,16,010	10,17,660	10,13,322	**10,05,245**	**68.5%**
Government-aided	81,690	81,486	80,313	79,349	**79,261**	**5.4%**
Private unaided recognised	3,43,314	3,23,430	3,31,108	3,39,583	**3,41,689**	**23.3%**
Others (incl. unrecognised)	32,340	45,183	42,810	39,219	**40,487**	**2.8%**
Total	15,09,136	14,66,109	14,71,891	14,71,473	**14,66,682**	100%
Memo: recognised madrasas	19,613	19,113	20,512	19,690	19,145	—

From 2022-23, recognised madrasas are counted inside the four management rows. Before that they were a separate residual, so the "Others" series is not comparable across that break (EFA key indicators). UDISE+ also counts only schools that hold a UDISE code. Unrecognised schools without one are invisible, so the private segment is somewhat larger than shown.

Enrolment is drifting down, and the 2022-23 fall is mostly a data artefact

Classes 1-12 enrolment was **23.23 crore in 2025-26**. Adding pre-primary gives 24.72 crore. Primary enrolment (Classes 1-5) is shrinking by about 2-2.5% a year, while upper primary (Classes 6-8) is roughly flat (EFA 2025-26 analysis). The sharp 1.41 crore drop between 2021-22 and 2022-23 coincides with UDISE+ switching to **student-wise, Aadhaar-linked records**. The Ministry says this switch "weeded out ghost students" enrolled in both a government and a private school (Outlook). Demographics account for the slower decline since then: the projected 6-10 population fell from 11.49 crore to 11.40 crore in one year (EFA 2025-26 analysis).

Table 2. Enrolment by level (UDISE+; 2021-22 is not comparable with later years) — source: EFA key indicators

Level	2021-22	2022-23	2024-25	2025-26	Change 2024-25 to 2025-26
Pre-primary	94,95,207	1,01,67,812	1,40,47,080	1,49,12,909	+8.7 lakh (not comparable across years)
Primary (1-5)	12,18,42,250	11,24,21,298	10,43,81,347	**10,19,15,874**	-24.7 lakh (-2.4%)
Upper primary (6-8)	6,67,90,692	6,34,77,860	6,36,95,100	**6,32,41,424**	-4.5 lakh (-0.7%)
Secondary (9-10)	3,85,28,631	3,79,34,094	3,71,65,436	3,82,90,413	+11.2 lakh
Higher secondary (11-12)	2,85,79,050	2,77,90,658	2,76,43,717	2,88,59,146	+12.2 lakh
Classes 1-12	25,57,40,623	24,16,23,910	23,28,85,600	**23,23,06,857**	-5.8 lakh (-0.25%)
Pre-primary to 12	26,52,35,830	25,17,91,722	24,69,32,680	**24,72,19,766**	+2.9 lakh

UDISE+ publishes no grade-wise totals in the sources accessed, so this report estimates the Classes 3-8 band. Classes 3-5 are taken as three-fifths of primary enrolment and added to Classes 6-8. Because cohorts are shrinking, the youngest grades are the smallest, so this method slightly understates Classes 3-5. The management split applies the 2025-26 Classes 1-12 shares, because UDISE+ gives no management-by-level table.

Table 3. Classes 3-8 enrolment (est.) — derived from Table 2 and the management shares in EFA 2025-26 analysis

Estimate	2024-25	2025-26
Classes 3-5 (3/5 of Classes 1-5)	6.26 crore	6.11 crore
Classes 6-8 (official)	6.37 crore	6.32 crore
Classes 3-8	**12.63 crore**	**12.44 crore**
of which government (49.66%)	—	6.18 crore
of which government-aided (10.45%)	—	1.30 crore
of which private unaided (37.97%)	—	4.72 crore
of which others (1.91%)	—	0.24 crore

On a Classes 1-12 basis, management shares in 2025-26 were government 49.66% (11.54 crore), aided 10.45% (2.43 crore), private unaided 37.97% (8.82 crore) and others 1.91% (0.44 crore) (EFA NEP distribution). The widely quoted headline that **"private schools cross 40%"** includes pre-primary, which is about 71% private (EFA private 40%). For a Classes 3-8 product, the 38% figure is the right one to use.

Household surveys put the government share higher than the UDISE+ school census does. The NSS Comprehensive Modular Survey on Education (Apr-Jun 2025) found **55.9% of enrolment in government schools** and 31.9% in private unaided recognised schools. It found 66.0% government in rural areas against 30.1% in urban areas (News on AIR). ASER 2024 found 66.8% of rural 6-14-year-olds in government schools, down from 72.9% in 2022 (ASER 2024 via

PARI). A census of school records and a survey of households measure different things, so neither is wrong. Both say the same thing for a coding programme: in rural India, private schools serve about one child in three.

Most schools are small, and the Classes 3-8 band crosses school types

UDISE+ classifies a school by the highest level it offers. In 2025-26 there were 7,22,498 primary, 4,32,374 upper-primary, 1,43,200 secondary and 1,68,610 higher-secondary schools (EFA NEP distribution). Primary-category schools are numerous but thin. In 2024-25 they were **49.6% of schools and held 48.0% of enrolment, but only 23.4% of teachers** (UDISE+ 2024-25 Table 2.1). **36.4% of all schools had 50 or fewer students** in 2024-25 (EFA small schools). Every primary school teaches Classes 3-5 and every upper-primary school teaches Classes 6-8. This report therefore estimates that 12-14 lakh schools teach part of the 3-8 band. Only composite schools (Classes 1-8, 1-10 or 1-12) teach all of it, probably 4.5-7 lakh schools **(est.)**; UDISE+ Table 3.1, which would settle this, was not readable.

One crore teachers, stretched thinnest in aided schools

Table 4. Teachers by management, 2025-26 — counts from EFA key indicators; PTR and per-school figures are this report's arithmetic (pre-primary-to-12 enrolment ÷ teachers)

Management	Teachers	Share	Change since 2022-23	Pupil-teacher ratio (est.)	Teachers per school
Government	51,34,623	50.0%	+2.4 lakh	23	5.1
of which KVs / JNVs	50,315 / 15,774	—	—	—	—
Government-aided	7,60,462	7.4%	-0.3 lakh	32	9.6
Private unaided	41,07,232	40.0%	+5.8 lakh (+16.6%)	24	12.0
Others	2,70,703	2.6%	-0.04 lakh	18	6.7
Total	**1,02,73,020**	100%	+7.9 lakh	**24**	7.0

Teachers passed 1 crore for the first time in 2024-25 (Careers360). Private unaided staffing is growing fastest. About **23.6 lakh teachers work in primary-category schools and 28.7 lakh in upper-primary-category schools**, roughly 52 lakh in all. That is the upper bound for a Classes 3-8 teacher-training effort, since not all of them teach these grades (EFA NEP distribution). **1,00,843 schools (6.9%) have a single teacher** and enrol 29.1 lakh pupils. Andhra Pradesh (16,357) and Jharkhand (9,827) have the most (EFA single-teacher schools). In such schools one generalist teaches every subject, so a CT&AI programme there has to be fully scripted.

Private schooling is mostly budget schooling

The NSS education survey (2025) puts average household spending at **Rs 25,002 a year per non-government student** (rural Rs 19,554, urban Rs 31,782), against Rs 2,863 per government student (Dataful). The latest fee distribution is older, from Central Square Foundation's analysis of 2017-18 NSS data: **70% of private-school students paid under Rs 1,000 a month and 45% under Rs 500** (CSF fact sheet). On those figures, a Rs 449 pack costs about 2.3% of a rural private family's annual schooling spend and 1.4% of an urban family's. For a school charging Rs 500 a month, it equals 7-8% of a year's tuition **(est.)**. The pack is affordable as a booklist item, but it will be noticed.

Six private-heavy states hold half the private Classes 3-8 pool

Enrolment is concentrated. The 15 largest states hold about 87% of students, and Uttar Pradesh alone holds 17.3% (UDISE+ 2024-25 Table 2.1). Management mix varies far more than size. Telangana, Haryana, Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Rajasthan have **more than half of enrolment in private unaided schools**. West Bengal (6.3%) and Bihar (13.5-14.8%) are overwhelmingly government. Maharashtra and Kerala are aided-school systems (EFA private 40%).

Table 5. Largest states: size, management and estimated Classes 3-8 pool. Schools, enrolment and teachers are for 2024-25 from official UDISE+ 2024-25 Table 2.1. School shares by management are from EFA role of private schools 2024-25. Private enrolment shares are for 2025-26 from EFA private 40%. Estimated columns take 50% of pre-primary-to-12 enrolment as Classes 3-8 (the national ratio), multiplied by the private share.

State	Schools	Enrolment (PP-12)	Teachers	Students per school	Private unaided % of schools	Aided % of schools	Private unaided % of enrolment (2025-26)	Classes 3-8 (est.)	Private Classes 3-8 (est.)
India	14,71,473	24,69,32,680	1,01,22,420	168	23.1	5.4	40.0 (PP-12) / 38.0 (1-12)	12.4 crore	4.7 crore
Uttar Pradesh	2,62,358	4,27,89,347	16,15,427	163	39.8	3.1	54.0	2.14 crore	1.16 crore
Maharashtra	1,08,250	2,12,72,611	7,47,501	197	17.3	22.6	n/a (aided 45.6)	1.06 crore	n/a
Bihar	94,339	2,11,33,228	7,07,516	224	11.9	0.8	14.8 (alt. 13.5)	1.06 crore	16 lakh
West Bengal	93,715	1,70,81,511	5,83,825	182	7.6	0.1	6.3	85 lakh	5 lakh
Rajasthan	1,06,302	1,63,64,187	7,92,265	154	31.5	0.0	52.5	82 lakh	43 lakh
Madhya Pradesh	1,22,120	1,51,72,607	7,17,493	124	23.1	0.5	n/a	76 lakh	n/a
Tamil Nadu	57,935	1,25,18,167	5,49,850	216	20.5	14.2	n/a	63 lakh	n/a
Karnataka	74,859	1,17,80,251	4,52,602	157	25.5	9.2	n/a	59 lakh	n/a
Gujarat	53,355	1,15,01,328	3,89,063	216	24.7	10.4	n/a	58 lakh	n/a
Andhra Pradesh	61,317	84,54,817	3,42,721	138	25.2	1.4	57.4	42 lakh	24 lakh
Odisha	61,565	76,44,052	3,44,116	124	9.9	9.5	21.1	38 lakh	8 lakh
Telangana	43,154	74,57,851	3,57,911	173	28.9	1.3	64.5	37 lakh	24 lakh
Jharkhand	44,376	74,36,931	2,09,203	168	3.9	2.6	n/a	37 lakh	n/a
Assam	55,283	70,41,824	3,40,471	127	11.7	2.9	n/a	35 lakh	n/a
Kerala	15,757	61,64,059	2,92,072	391	19.2	45.5	31.3 (2024-25)	31 lakh	10 lakh
Punjab	27,281	59,08,507	2,73,130	217	27.9	1.6	53.3	30 lakh	16 lakh
Haryana	23,494	57,69,330	2,63,942	246	36.2	0.0	61.9	29 lakh	18 lakh
Delhi	5,556	44,91,032	1,61,958	808	47.5	4.3	n/a	22 lakh	n/a

Two cautions apply to Table 5. First, the state private shares appear to include pre-primary, so they slightly overstate the private share of Classes 3-8. Second, the estimated columns mix 2024-25 enrolment with 2025-26 shares. Even so, the pattern is robust. Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Haryana and Punjab together hold about **2.4 crore private Classes 3-8 students, roughly half the national private pool (est.)**. **Uttar Pradesh alone has about 1.2 crore (est.)**, more than the central estimate for the whole CBSE segment described below. The Kerala private share (31.3%) is a 2024-25 figure (EFA size premium). One EFA page carries a "private enrolment %" column

with values such as UP 14.59%. Those values conflict with that page's own school shares and appear mislabelled, so they are not used here.

Central and residential networks are few, large and centrally bought

The schools India's public imagination associates with quality are a small slice of the system: Kendriya Vidyalayas, Navodayas, Sainik and Army schools. Together they number a few thousand. Their buying is central, through KVS, NVS, the Ministry of Defence or the Army Welfare Education Society. For CodeSchool that makes them reference customers and institutional deals, not booklist sales.

Table 6. Special school categories (counts and dates as reported; "n/f" = not found)

Category	Schools	Students	Model and admission	Board	Source
Kendriya Vidyalayas (KVS)	**1,366** on the KVS site (3 abroad; page dated 6 Nov 2026, figures' as-on date not stated). Lok Sabha, Jul 2025: 1,280 functioning. UDISE+ 2025-26: 1,286. 85 new KVs sanctioned Dec 2024; 57 more approved in 2025 to open from 2026-27	**14.07 lakh** (KVS site); 13.51 lakh in 2024-25, a five-year low; new admissions down 28.4% since 2020-21	Central government day schools, Classes 1-12; priority for transferable central employees (not re-verified)	CBSE	KVS; Careers360; News on AIR; BW Education
Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas (NVS)	**653 functional** of 661 sanctioned, in 27 states and 8 UTs (not Tamil Nadu). UDISE+ 2025-26: 665. 28 more approved Dec 2024	**3.11 lakh** (30 Sep 2025); 2.88 lakh (2023-24)	Free, co-educational, residential, Classes 6-12; up to 80 Class 6 seats per school via JNVST	CBSE	Lok Sabha; narendramodi.in; Wikipedia; Careers360
Sainik Schools, original	**33** in 24 states/UTs	n/f	Residential, Classes 6-12, via AISSEE (residential and CBSE status widely reported, not re-verified)	CBSE	PIB, Sep 2023; Tribune
New Sainik Schools (partnership mode)	**86 approved** by Jun 2025 against a target of 100. AISSEE 2026 offered Class 6 seats in 69 and Class 9 seats in 19	n/f. Unofficial seat list: 9,417 Class 6 seats in new schools	NGO, private or state partner schools, residential or day-boarding. Government pays 50% of fees, capped at Rs 40,000 a year, for up to 50 students per class; no infrastructure grant. At least 40% of seats from the AISSEE merit list	Partner school's board	PIB 2021; Careers360, Jun 2025; Careers360, Oct 2025
Army Public Schools (AWES)	**137**, plus about 250 Army pre-primary schools	About 2.4 lakh (undated)	Day schools in cantonments and military stations	CBSE	Wikipedia: AWES
Rashtriya Military Schools	5	n/f	Ministry of Defence, residential, entrance test	CBSE	ESM Corner
Atomic Energy Education Society	30-31 schools and colleges	25,000-26,000	Children of Department of Atomic Energy staff	CBSE and some state boards	AEES
Central Tibetan Schools	14 (older figure)	n/f	—	CBSE	Wikipedia: CBSE

Category	Schools	Students	Model and admission	Board	Source
Eklavya Model Residential Schools	**728 approved; 477-479 functional** (Jun to late 2025). One Dec 2025 headline says 440	**1.38 lakh** in 479 schools	Tribal residential schools (Classes 6-12 and CBSE affiliation commonly reported, not verified)	n/f	The Hawk; Careers360; News on AIR
Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas	**5,639 sanctioned; 5,269 functional** (5 Dec 2025)	**7.58 lakh girls**; retention in higher classes about 50%	Girls' residential schools under Samagra Shiksha	State	Careers360; News on AIR, Feb 2026
State welfare residential societies (example: Telangana TGSWREIS)	268 (plus 165 tribal and 205 minority societies' schools)	About 1.45 lakh (TGSWREIS)	Class 5 to undergraduate	State	TGSWREIS
All residential schools (UDISE+)	**47,388** (2025-26), up from 46,517	n/f	Includes the networks above, private boarding schools and state hostels or ashram schools	Mixed	EFA, Jul 2026
PM SHRI schools	**13,076** selected by Aug 2025 (9,373 rural); 13,092 by Jul 2026, against a target of 14,500+	n/f	Upgraded model schools. Outlay Rs 27,360 crore (central share Rs 18,128 crore), funding ICT labs, smart classrooms and tinkering labs. UP has the most (1,888)	Mixed	Tribune; Organiser; Business Standard

Residential schools matter for delivery as well as numbers. Children live on campus, so a boarding school can run evening sessions or clubs on its shared devices, which a day school cannot. The government's own 620-JNV PM SHRI plan (News on AIR) points to better-equipped labs in that network. KVs and NVS also helped design the CT&AI framework, so expect them to use the official NCERT/CBSE resources first.

CBSE's 33,248 schools are 2% of the system but carry the mandate

Table 7. Board affiliation counts (affiliations overlap: some schools hold more than one, so the rows are not additive)

Board	Schools	Reference date and notes	Source
CBSE	**33,248** (about 240 abroad in 28 countries, so about 33,000 in India)	Live counter, accessed 6 Nov 2026. Earlier figures: 29,179 (2024), 28,577 and 30,786 (2025, third-party)	CBSE SARAS; Wikipedia: CBSE; Sarkari List
CBSE by type (outdated, about 2018-19)	16,741 independent; 3,011 government; 1,138 KV; 595 JNV; 14 Central Tibetan	Independent schools were 78% of the total	Wikipedia: CBSE
CISCE (ICSE/ISC)	**About 2,600-3,300**	Sources disagree; no official count fetched	Wikipedia: CISCE; CISCE locator (unofficial)
International Baccalaureate	**276-278**	Up from 192 in 2020 (2025)	IBO India; The Federal
Cambridge International	**"Over 800"** in India, out of 1,034 in South Asia	Jul 2025; 53% of the region's schools are in Tier 1 cities	Cambridge International
State boards or no board	**About 14.3 lakh (est.)**	Residual of 14.67 lakh. Elementary schools often have no board affiliation	Derived

CBSE affiliations grew by about 4,000 between 2024 and late 2026, roughly 7% a year. That growth makes the mandate market a moving target worth tracking. If the old 78% independent share still holds, about **26,000 of the CBSE schools in India are private independent schools (est.)**. About 2,200 are central-government or defence-society schools: KVs, JNVs, APS, Sainik, RMS, AEES and Central Tibetan schools. The remainder are

state-government schools affiliated to CBSE. There is no current official breakdown by type.

Two in three schools are online, but one in five has a projector

Digital coverage has risen steeply. School internet rose from 7.3% in 2013-14 to 67.4% in 2025-26 (Manorama Yearbook). The headline figures still overstate teaching capacity. UDISE+ asks whether a school has a facility and records a self-reported yes or no. It does not count units or check whether they work. "Internet" may mean a teacher's phone, and "computer" may mean one tablet in the office (IJERT).

Table 8. Teaching infrastructure, all-India (share of schools with at least one, UDISE+) — sources: EFA electricity/internet; EFA digital divide; Elets; EFA 2024-25 infrastructure

Indicator	Schools 2025-26	% 2025-26	% 2024-25	Schools without (2025-26)
Electricity connection	13,93,201	95.0	93.6-93.7	73,481
Functional electricity	13,71,596	93.5	92.0	95,086 (incl. 21,605 connected but not working)
Solar panels	1,68,000	11.5	10.9	—
Computer facility (any)	10,25,842	69.9	64.7	4,40,840
Computer functional for teaching	9,24,831	**63.1**	57.9-58.0	**5,41,851**
Internet	9,89,191	**67.4**	63.5	4,77,491
Functional desktop/PC	5,35,000	**36.5**	n/f	about 9.3 lakh
Functional laptop	3,05,832	20.9	n/f	—
Functional tablet	4,55,175	31.0	n/f	—
PC with integrated teaching-learning device	1,53,390	10.5	n/f	—
Functional projector	3,24,842	**22.1**	n/f	about 11.4 lakh
Smart classroom (smart board, virtual classroom, smart TV)	4,97,811	**33.9**	24.4 (2023-24)	about 9.7 lakh
Mobile phones used for teaching	3,99,984	27.3	n/f	—
Digital library	1,04,765	7.1	n/f	—
Functional ICT lab (asked only of government and aided schools with Class 6+)	—	23.0 (government), 20.7 (aided)	n/f	—

Weighted by enrolment, coverage is a few points higher, because larger schools are better equipped. 72.7% of students attend a school with a computer, 66.3% one with a teaching computer, 71.0% one with internet and 35.8% one with a smart classroom (IJERT). The most useful single number is IJERT's modelled **joint floor**: the share of schools with both a teaching-usable device and internet. Its bounds run from 30.5% to 63.1%, with a model estimate of about 54%. Requiring electricity as well lowers the bound to 24.0%. These are model estimates, not UDISE+ outputs.

Table 9. Trend in core indicators (share of schools; data up to 2021-22 is not strictly comparable with later years)

Year	Computer facility	Internet	Electricity	Smart classroom	Source
2013-14	24.1	7.3	—	—	EduAdvice
2019-20	about 39	about 22	—	—	PIB, Economic Survey
2022-23	47.7	49.7	—	—	UDISE+ 2022-23 booklet
2023-24	57.2 (Mehta: 57.7)	53.9	91.8	24.4	Careers360/PTI; Sea and Job
2024-25	64.7	63.5	93.6-93.7	—	EFA 2024-25

Year	Computer facility	Internet	Electricity	Smart classroom	Source
2025-26	69.9	67.4	95.0	33.9	EFA

Government schools lag most on working hardware

The gap between management types is widest for real working machines and narrowest for connectivity. Government schools lead only on tablets, which reflects state tablet schemes. **Only 25.5% of government schools have a working desktop and 11.7% a working laptop.** They have improved by about 1.8 percentage points a year since 2022-23 (IJERT; Newslaundry).

Table 10. Infrastructure by management, 2025-26 (% of schools) — sources: IJERT; Sea and Job; Elets; EFA digital divide

Indicator	Government	Aided	Private unaided	Others
Share of schools / of enrolment (PP-12)	68.5 / 48.1	5.4 / 10.0	23.3 / 40.0	2.8 / 2.0
Students per school	118	311	289	—
Computer facility	66.9	76.6	80	—
Computer used for teaching	59.4 (52.7 in 2024-25)	73.7	74	—
Internet	63.1 (46.2 in 2023-24)	79.7	79.2	—
Smart classroom	32.2 (21.2 in 2023-24)	41	39.9 (34.6 in 2023-24)	—
Functional desktop	**25.5**	62.6	**63.2**	32.9
Functional laptop	11.7	—	44.8	—
Functional tablet	**39.3**	—	14.4	—
Functional projector	16.6	45.8	—	—
Functional ICT lab (Class 6+ schools only)	23.0	20.7	not asked	not asked
Joint device + internet floor (IJERT model)	**22.5**	53.4	**53.2**	—

Government schools contributed 11.6 of the 13.5-point national internet gain since 2023-24 (IJERT), so connectivity is catching up faster than devices. Private unaided schools are not uniformly ready either. A quarter lack a teaching computer, and about 60% lack a smart classroom. Budget private schools are an estimated 79% of private unaided schools (LinkedIn, citing CCS; a secondary source) and probably account for most of that gap. No survey splits device access by fee tier.

Delhi and the south are wired; the Hindi heartland, Bengal and the north-east are not

Table 11. State extremes (UDISE+ 2025-26 unless marked) — sources: EFA electricity/internet; EFA digital divide; Elets; IJERT; EFA 2024-25

State	Internet %	Computer for teaching %	Functional desktop % (all / government)	Smart classroom %	Other notes
Delhi	100	over 90	99.7 / —	—	Computer facility 99.9%
Punjab	—	over 90	— / **95.2**	**81.5**	ICT lab: 45.6% report one, 9.8% working
Tamil Nadu	99	over 90	— / 85.8	—	100% electricity
Kerala	92.6	over 90	—	—	About 7 laptops and 4 projectors per public school (2018-19 KITE stock) (Gulf News)
Gujarat	96.8	over 90	—	—	—

State	Internet %	Computer for teaching %	Functional desktop % (all / government)	Smart classroom %	Other notes
Haryana	—	over 90	—	—	Smart classrooms: government 42.6% vs private 63.9% (2024-25) (Tribune)
Andhra Pradesh	99.2	—	—	—	—
Uttar Pradesh	45.9 (2024-25)	61.8	22.0 / **6.4**	—	26,151 schools without electricity, the largest number of any state
Bihar	**91.0**	38.4	17.7 / 9.5	—	Internet far ahead of devices (phone-based?)
Madhya Pradesh	—	—	20.9 / 7.6	—	—
Rajasthan	—	—	—	—	Joint device + internet floor only 19.2% (IJERT est.)
Jharkhand	58.0 (2024-25)	57.1	—	—	Computer facility 81.2%
Chhattisgarh	—	38.6	—	—	61.4% report a computer
Assam	—	—	16.6 / —	—	—
West Bengal	**19.7**	24.3	—	**5.1**	Reports through its own system, so figures may partly reflect reporting differences
Meghalaya	36.4	**17.4**	**13.8** / 7.6	5.8	**69.0% of schools without electricity**

Sanctions run far ahead of working labs

Government schemes approve far more equipment than reaches classrooms. The schemes that are growing also target secondary schools rather than Classes 3-8.

Table 12. Infrastructure schemes: approved vs delivered

Scheme	Approved / promised	Delivered / functional	Date	Source
Samagra Shiksha ICT labs, 2021-22 to 2025-26	73,308	37,511 (**51%**)	Parliamentary reply	Kashmir Life
Samagra Shiksha smart classrooms, 2021-22 to 2025-26	1,36,382	82,856 (**61%**)	Same reply	Kashmir Life
ICT labs, cumulative	1,56,213 (to 31 May 2025); 1,76,669 (PRABANDH, Aug 2025)	n/f	2025	Lok Sabha AU1238; Tribune
Smart classrooms, cumulative	1,46,040 (31 May 2025); 1,76,728 (10 Nov 2025; UP 34,533, MP 12,573, Odisha 11,776, Bihar 11,586)	n/f	2025	DD News; Careers360
Smart classroom funding norm	Rs 2.40 lakh non-recurring for two smart classrooms per school, plus Rs 38,000 recurring	—	2025	DD News
Atal Tinkering Labs	50,000 more in government schools over 5 years (Budget 2025-26); schools with Classes 6-12	About 10,000 (Oct to Dec 2025)	2025	PIB
BharatNet school broadband	All rural government secondary schools within 3 years; 16,071 schools in Phase 1	No completion figure	2025	BharatNet; Careers360
State examples	Delhi: Rs 900+ crore for 18,966 smart classrooms (Classes 9-12) by 2029-30. UP: Rs 300 crore to make 14,429 primary schools "smart"	Delhi installed only 799 smart boards in 2014-2024	2025	ThePrint; BW Education
Non-functional equipment	Karnataka: about 60% of government ICT labs non-functional (headline)	—	—	Deccan Herald

Even 50,000 new tinkering labs would cover only about 5% of government schools, and only Classes 6 and above. Phase 1 of BharatNet reaches about 16,000 schools against 4.8 lakh with no internet. **Classes 3-5 classrooms will see almost no new devices from central schemes before 2027-28 (est.).** At the current 4-7 points a year, about a quarter to a third of schools will still lack a working teaching computer in 2027-28.

Print, TV and a parent's phone still carry learning

The state's own learning-support system already works through print with digital add-ons. NCERT textbooks for Classes 1-8 cost **Rs 65 a copy**. NCERT is scaling print from about 4-5 crore copies a year towards 15 crore (Business Standard). Samagra Shiksha funds free textbooks for Classes 1-8 in government and aided schools, often handed out on the first day of the session (Free Press Journal). Those textbooks carry QR codes that link to DIKSHA content.

Table 13. Public learning-support channels

Channel	Scale	Reach evidence	Reference date	Source
DIKSHA (NCERT/CIET)	7,687 QR-coded textbooks; 3.67 lakh content items; 135 languages; 614+ virtual labs; downloadable, and states preload it on smart boards for offline use	2.25 crore registered users; **about 3 lakh daily active users**; 575 crore cumulative sessions (562 crore in May 2025, so growth has plateaued)	27 Jun 2026	PIB DIKSHA factsheet; BJET
DIKSHA teacher courses	347 courses	18.77 crore enrolments; 12.79 crore certificates	27 Jun 2026	PIB DIKSHA factsheet
PM eVidya TV	200 DTH channels, "one class, one channel", Classes 1-12, on DD Free Dish (expanded from 12 in Budget 2022-23); Indian Sign Language channel from Dec 2024	**No viewership data**; CIET has published a critical review of channel use	2025-26	SWAYAM Prabha; CIET review
PM eVidya radio and podcasts	About 400 stations (CIET: 3 GyanVani, 257 community, 132 AIR) plus iRadio and JioSaavn; 4,476+ curriculum radio programmes	**No listenership data**	Feb 2025 (Lok Sabha)	Lok Sabha AU188; CIET brochure
Free textbooks (Samagra Shiksha)	Classes 1-8, government and aided schools; NCERT price benchmark Rs 65	No national beneficiary count found. Example: Nashik, 19.3 lakh copies for 4.66 lakh pupils	2023-2025	Business Standard; Free Press Journal
e-Jaadui Pitara	Digital foundational-stage play kit (app and web)	n/f	Launched 10 Feb 2024	Rajya Sabha
Teacher training (NISHTHA)	63.17 lakh teachers trained 2019-22; cyber-safety training for 3.83 lakh since Oct 2021	No CT&AI-specific training figure	Dec 2024	News on AIR

CBSE and the Ministry launched a **CT&AI curriculum for Classes 3-8 from the 2026-27 session** (reported 1 April 2026). NCERT, KVS and NVS helped frame it (Business Standard; Careers360). This project read the circulars directly (CBSE verification). Circular Acad-15/2026 (1 April 2026) says schools are "advised" to adopt it, at **50 hours a year in Classes 3-5** (inside Mathematics and TWAU) and **100 hours in Classes 6-8** (40 CT, 20 AI, 40 projects). Circular Acad-18/2026 uses stronger wording (the curriculum "mandates" its content) and posts **free student and teacher resource books** that schools "should download". All twelve books were reviewed for this project (CBSE handbook review): they need no devices, but they include no coding, project materials or rubrics. **CodeSchool therefore competes against a zero-price official baseline** and must sell on what the free books lack (coding, project kits, AI activities, teacher scripts and assessment), not on content alone. The Budget's AI-related items all target older students or higher education: a Rs 500 crore AI Centre of Excellence for education, the tinkering labs, BharatNet for secondary schools, and AVGC content-creator labs in 15,000 secondary schools announced in Budget 2026-27 (MoE Budget release; ThePrint).

Home access means a shared parent's phone on mobile data

Table 14. Household and youth digital access

Measure	Value	Population and date	Source
Households with at least one smartphone	**85.5%**	All households, Jan-Mar 2025 (CAMS Telecom, NSS 80th round)	PIB/MoSPI
Households with internet in the premises	86.3% (rural 83.3%, urban 91.6%)	Same	PIB/MoSPI
Fixed or Wi-Fi connection	**Rural 9.1%, urban 24%**	Same; mobile data was the access mode for 98.1% of rural internet users	PIB/MoSPI
Internet use in the past 3 months, age 15+	70% (men 76.7%, women 63.1%)	Same	PIB/MoSPI
Smartphone at home	**About 90%**	Rural 14-16-year-olds, ASER 2024 (secondary reports)	Business Standard
Owns a smartphone	**About 31%** (boys 36.2%, girls 26.9%), up from 19% in 2022	Same	Ideas for India
Could get a phone on survey day	Boys 70.2%, girls 62.2%	Same	Business Standard
Used a phone for education in the past week	57% (76% for social media)	Same	Business Standard
Rural tele-density	61.05% (urban 154.12%); rural wireline 0.57%	TRAI, Jul 2026 and Mar 2026 quarter	TRAI PR 135/2026; TRAI PR 127/2026

No national survey measures device access for children aged 8-13, the Classes 3-8 band. ASER's digital module covers only ages 14-16. If a third of rural teenagers own a phone and girls trail boys by about 8 points on day-of access, younger children will mostly borrow a parent's phone, intermittently. **Take-home digital work can be optional enrichment, not a dependency.** Private edtech has reached the same conclusion. The firms that survived the 2022-24 correction sell print-plus-classroom kits to affordable private schools. LEAD Group works with about 8,500 schools, 90% of them outside metros, and targets about 10,000 in 2026 (Business Standard). Uolo raised US$7 million in 2025 for school partnerships (Inc42).

Four data breaks limit how far the numbers stretch

Table 15. Data-quality caveats and how this report handles them

Caveat	What it affects	Handling here
UDISE+ 2022-23 methodology break. UDISE+ moved from school-level returns to student-wise, Aadhaar-linked records, and the reference date moved from 30 September to 31 March (Outlook; EFA key indicators)	Enrolment trends. The 1.41 crore fall between 2021-22 and 2022-23 is largely de-duplication; madrasa accounting also changed	Trends use 2022-23 onwards. Pre-primary is not compared across years
Presence, not count. UDISE+ records whether a school has at least one device of a type, as a self-reported flag (IJERT)	All device figures. No unit counts, no student-to-computer ratio and no bandwidth data. A school with one tablet counts as "has a computer"	Readiness is read from the stricter indicators (teaching computer, desktop, projector, joint floor), not "computer facility"
Sanctioned vs functional. ICT labs 51% complete; smart classrooms 61%; EMRS 477 of 722-728 functional; KGBV 370 non-functional; JNV 653 of 661; Punjab ICT labs 45.6% reported vs 9.8% working	Infrastructure schemes and special-school counts	Functional counts are used where available; sanctions are reported only as pipeline

Caveat	What it affects	Handling here
Conflicting sources	See Table 16	Ranges are shown; the better-supported figure is used
Secondary compilation. The official 2024-25 and 2025-26 booklets (over 10 MB) and PIB pages could not be read	National and state UDISE+ figures	The figures rest on EFA (Prof. Mehta) and IJERT, which cite the booklet tables. Management rows were checked to sum to totals
School-weighted vs student-weighted	Infrastructure shares	Shares are school-weighted unless stated. Student-weighted shares run 2-4 points higher
Census vs household survey. NSS CMS gives a 55.9% government share against 48-50% in UDISE+; ASER is rural only	Management shares	UDISE+ is used for sizing; surveys are used for the rural/urban split and spending
West Bengal reports through its own system	West Bengal's very low digital figures	Treated as a floor, not a precise value
Policy wording. CBSE's Acad-15/2026 "advises" schools to adopt CT&AI, while Acad-18/2026 says the curriculum "mandates" its content (CBSE verification)	How "compulsory" the CBSE segment is	CBSE schools are treated as expected adopters, not legally bound buyers
This report's estimates	Classes 3-8 enrolment, CBSE students, state pools, per-school economics, online-capable shares	Each is marked (est.), with its method stated

Table 16. Conflicting figures

Item	Figure A	Figure B	Used here
Kendriya Vidyalayas	1,280 functioning (Lok Sabha, Jul 2025); 1,286 (UDISE+ 2025-26); 1,288 (2025 approval)	1,366 (KVS site, late 2026)	1,366 as current, likely including newly opened KVs
JNVs	653 functional, 661 sanctioned (NVS)	665 (UDISE+ 2025-26)	About 653-665
EMRS functional	477-479 (Lok Sabha; standing committee)	440 (Dec 2025 headline; probably the number of new EMRS proposed)	477-479
CBSE schools	33,248 (SARAS, Nov 2026)	29,179 (2024); 28,577 and 30,786 (2025, third-party)	33,248
CISCE schools	About 2,600 (school locator)	3,300+ (Wikipedia)	Range
Private enrolment share	38.0% (Classes 1-12)	40.0% (with pre-primary)	38.0% for Classes 3-8
Bihar private share	14.8%	13.5%	Range
Government-school enrolment drop, 2023-24 to 2024-25	59 lakh (from the table values)	"5.9 lakh" (article text; typo)	59 lakh
Functional electricity, 2025-26	95.0% is connected; some summaries call it functional	93.5% functional	93.5% functional
Teaching computer, 2024-25	57.9% (Elets)	58.0% (Mehta)	Either
ICT labs approved, cumulative	1,56,213 (to May 2025)	1,76,669 (Aug 2025)	Both, as a pipeline
UP smart classrooms approved	34,533 (article body)	35,533 (headline)	34,533
Meghalaya electricity	69.0% of schools without	"28.7%" (IJERT; probably share with)	About 69% without

CodeSchool's core market is about 33,000 CBSE schools and 88 lakh pupils (est.)

Sizing starts from the 12.44 crore Classes 3-8 students in Table 3 and splits them by who is required to teach CT&AI, who pays, and what infrastructure the school has. **Pack prices are per student per year at MRP**: Rs 449 for Classes 3-5, Rs 599 for Classes 6-8, or a Rs 299 + 18% GST (about Rs 353) online school licence. Classes 3-5 and 6-8 are almost equal in size (6.11 crore and 6.32 crore), so the blended pack price is **about Rs 525 per student (est.)**. Revenue pools below are gross MRP before channel margins and taxes.

Table 17. Market segments for a Classes 3-8 CT&AI programme, 2025-26 base (all student figures est.)

Segment	Schools	Classes 3-8 students	CT&AI status	Buyer	Best-fit product
A. CBSE private independent	About 26,000 (78% of about 33,000)	36 lakh to 1.3 crore; **central 78 lakh**	Expected from 2026-27 (CBSE "advises"; curriculum "mandates" content)	School, through the booklist or its own fees	Offline pack as default; Online licence where a lab or projector exists
B. CBSE central government and defence (KV, JNV, APS, Sainik, RMS, AEES, CTSA)	About 2,200	**About 9.5 lakh** (KV about 7.0 lakh, assuming half of Classes 1-12; JNV about 1.3 lakh, 3 of 7 grades; APS about 1.2 lakh)	Expected; KVS and NVS co-framed it	KVS, NVS, MoD or AWES centrally	Reference pilots; teacher support on top of official books
C. Premium non-CBSE (CISCE, IB, Cambridge)	About 3,700-4,400 affiliations (overlapping)	About 10-15 lakh (assuming 300 per school)	Not mandated; competitive pressure	School	Online licence; project packs
D. State-board private unaided and "others"	About 3.5 lakh	**About 4.1 crore**	Not mandated	School or parents; budget fees	Low-price offline; selective
E. Government-aided	79,261	About 1.30 crore	State policy	Management or state	Offline, through management associations
F. State government	About 10.0 lakh	About 6.1 crore	State choice	State Samagra Shiksha or textbook boards	Offline print licence at textbook-scale prices

The CBSE independent estimate is the least certain and the most important. No source gives CBSE enrolment by class across affiliated schools, so Table 18 uses three explicit assumptions about Classes 3-8 students per school.

Table 18. CBSE (segments A + B) sizing scenarios (est.)

Scenario	Assumed Classes 3-8 students per independent school	Basis	A: independent students	A + B total	Pack pool at Rs 525 MRP	Licence pool at Rs 299 ex-GST
Low	138	National private unaided average (4.72 crore ÷ 3.42 lakh)	36 lakh	45 lakh	Rs 238 crore	Rs 136 crore
Central	**300**	Assumption; CBSE schools are typically larger than the private average	**78 lakh**	**88 lakh**	**Rs 459 crore**	**Rs 262 crore**
High	500	About half of a KV's average roll (14.07 lakh ÷ 1,366 ≈ 1,030)	1.30 crore	1.40 crore	Rs 732 crore	Rs 417 crore

Two ratios put these numbers in context. Every 1% of segment D is about 4.1 lakh students, or about Rs 21 crore at pack MRP, so a small foothold in state-board private schools rivals a large share of CBSE. A state adopting a CT&AI

workbook for all its government Classes 3-8 pupils would buy at NCERT's Rs 65 benchmark, not Rs 449. At that price, all of segment F is a ceiling of about Rs 400 crore across every state, not a forecast **(est.)**.

Offline is the default product; online fits about half of private schools

Online readiness depends on the strictest relevant indicator. Teacher-led online lessons need one working device plus a projector or smart screen. Student-on-device lessons need several machines, which UDISE+ cannot confirm because it does not count units. Applying each management type's 2025-26 rates gives the ranges below. The private unaided averages include well-equipped CBSE schools, so budget state-board schools probably sit at the bottom of the range.

Table 19. Estimated online-capable schools by segment (est., from Table 10 rates)

Segment	Readiness proxy (2025-26)	Online-capable share	Online-capable schools	Offline-only schools
A. CBSE private independent	Private unaided: smart classroom 39.9%; joint device + internet floor 53.2%; desktop 63.2%	40-53% (likely higher for CBSE, unquantified)	**About 10,400-13,800**	About 12,200-15,600
D. State-board private	Same proxy, budget-skewed	25-50%	About 0.9-1.7 lakh	About 1.7-2.6 lakh
E. Aided	Smart classroom 41%; projector 45.8%; joint floor 53.4%	41-53%	About 32,000-42,000	About 37,000-47,000
F. Government	Projector 16.6%; joint floor 22.5%; desktop 25.5%; ICT lab 23.0% (Class 6+)	16-25%	About 1.6-2.5 lakh	About 7.5-8.4 lakh

Per-school economics point the same way. Averaged over all schools of each type, a private unaided school has about **138 Classes 3-8 students (est.)**. That is worth about Rs 72,000 a year at pack MRP, or about Rs 49,000 a year on the Rs 353 licence. An aided school (about 164 students) is worth about Rs 86,000 or Rs 58,000, and a government school (about 61 students) about Rs 32,000 or Rs 21,500. A central-scenario CBSE school (300 students) is worth about Rs 1.6 lakh on packs or Rs 1.06 lakh on the licence. The licence is about a third cheaper per student than the packs, so it suits device-rich premium schools that pay from their own budgets. The packs suit the larger number of schools whose families pay through the booklist.

Table 20. State priorities (combining Tables 5 and 11)

State group	States	Evidence	Lead product
Private-heavy and digitally ready	Haryana, Punjab, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Delhi	Private unaided 54-65% of enrolment (Delhi: 47.5% of schools); teaching computers over 90% (Haryana, Punjab, Delhi); internet 99%+ (AP, Delhi); Punjab smart classrooms 81.5%. Telangana's device data is incomplete	Online licence plus packs; hybrid pilots
Digitally ready, mixed management	Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Kerala	Internet 93-99%; teaching computers over 90%; large aided sectors (Kerala 45.5% of schools; Gujarat 10.4%; TN 14.2%)	Online licence in CBSE schools; aided-association channel
Private-heavy but digitally thin	Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan	UP: about 1.16 crore private Classes 3-8 students (est.), desktop 22.0%, internet 45.9% (2024-25). Rajasthan: 52.5% private, joint floor 19.2%	**Offline packs**; the largest single opportunity
Government-heavy and digitally thin	Bihar, West Bengal, Odisha, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya	Private shares 6-21% where known; desktops 14-21%; West Bengal internet 19.7%; Meghalaya 69% without electricity	Offline, through government procurement; private CBSE pockets only
Aided-heavy	Maharashtra	Aided schools hold 45.6% of enrolment	Management associations; offline

Conclusion

The CBSE mandate creates CodeSchool's first market, and it is narrow and dense: about 33,000 schools, roughly 2% of India's total, holding on the order of 88 lakh Classes 3-8 pupils (est.). Its size is uncertain within a factor of three, and the cheapest way to narrow that range is the school-level data UDISE+ already holds: board, class range and rural/urban location for every school. The larger prize is voluntary. Segment D, about 4 crore state-board private pupils, outweighs the entire CBSE segment several times over, and about half of all private Classes 3-8 pupils sit in six states, a quarter in Uttar Pradesh alone (est.). But this segment is price-sensitive and device-poor. That inverts the usual edtech logic. The printed workbook and unplugged kit are the scalable core, and the Online Programme is a premium tier for roughly the 10,000-14,000 CBSE schools and the aided and private schools that have a working screen.

The infrastructure data also implies a design rule. School connectivity is spreading faster than devices, and Bihar's 91% internet against 38% teaching computers is the clearest case. New central money is going to secondary schools. The device CodeSchool can most often count on in a Classes 3-8 classroom over the next two years is therefore a teacher's phone or a single shared screen, not a lab. A programme built for "one device at the front, paper on every desk" serves the whole system. One built for lab rotations serves perhaps a fifth of government schools and half of private ones. The free CBSE resource books and the official DIKSHA, TV and radio channels are not rivals to price against. They are a zero-cost baseline that sets what schools expect, and CodeSchool's value has to come from what the government does not supply: scripted teacher support, kits and assessment.

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